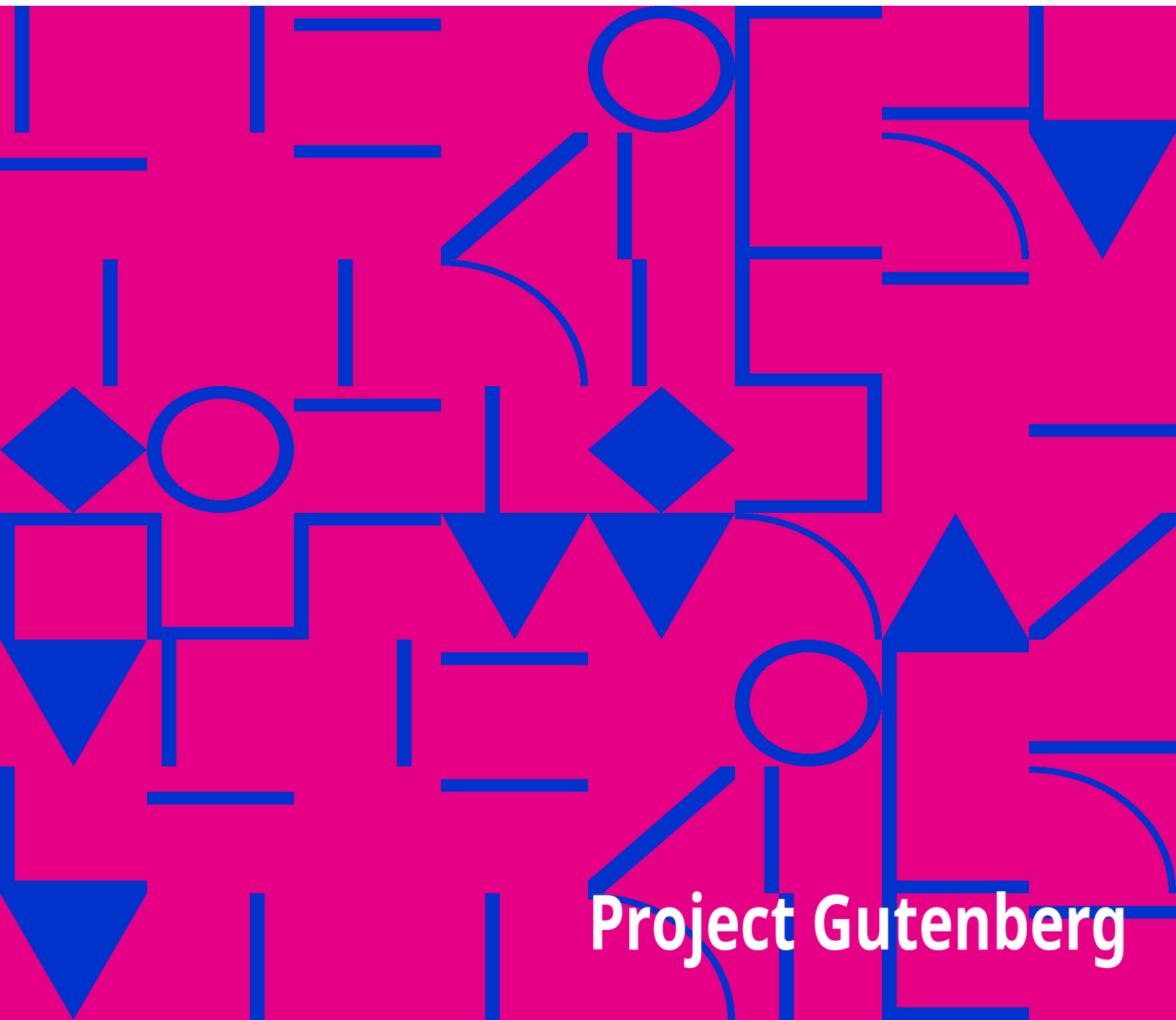


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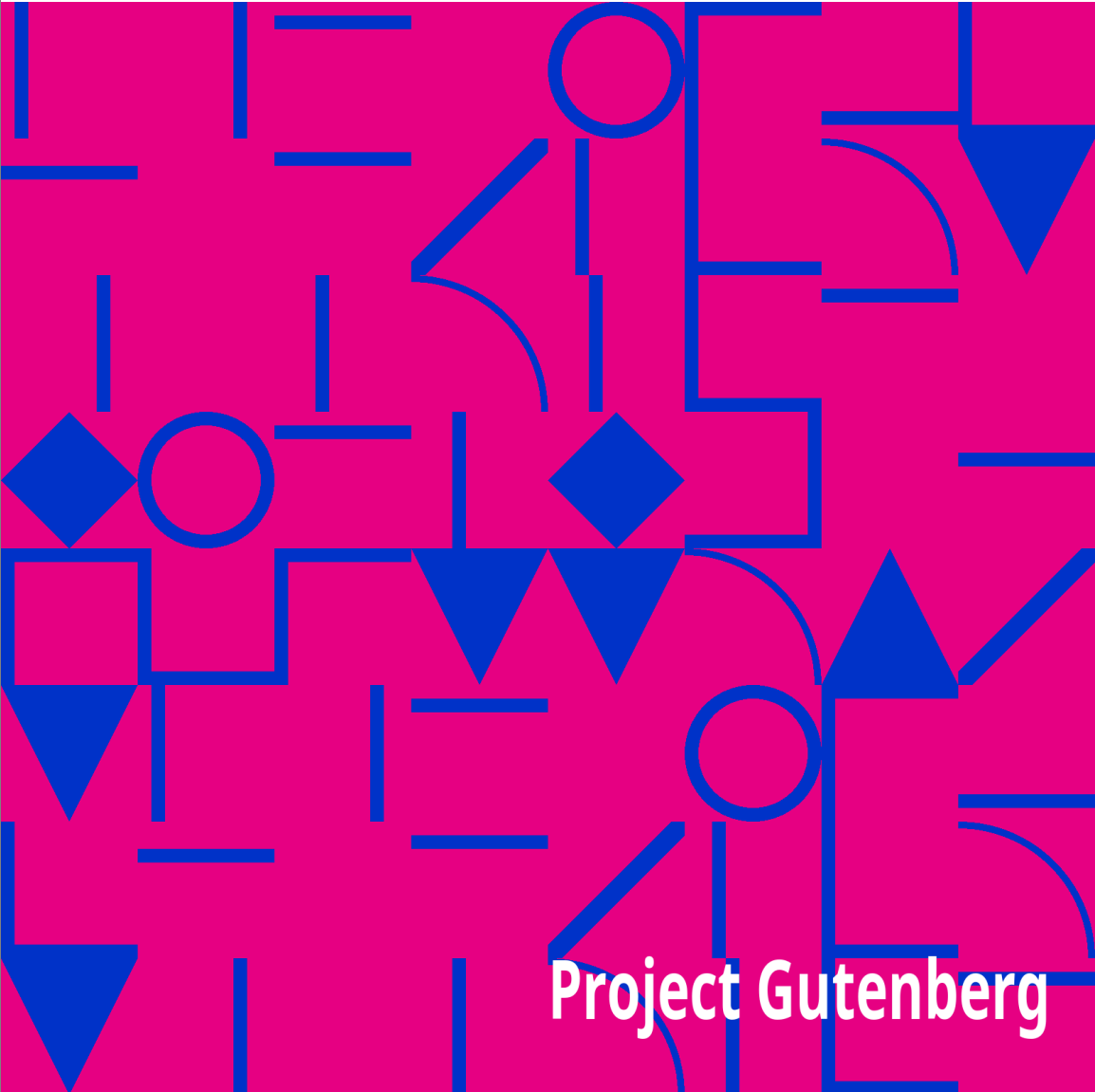
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Book 51 Colossians 001:001 Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus through the will of God, and Timothy our brother, 001:002 to the saints and faithful brothers{The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."} in Christ at Colossae: Grace to you and peace from God our Father, and the Lord Jesus Christ. 001:003 We give

**thanks to God the Father of our
Lord Jesus Christ, praying always
for you, 001:004 having heard of
your faith in Christ Jesus, and of
the love which you have toward all
the saints, 001:005 because of the
hope which is laid up for you in the
heavens, of which you heard before
in the word of the truth of the
Good News, 001:006 which has
come to you; even as it is in all the
world and is bearing fruit and
growing, as it does in you also,
since the day you heard and knew
the grace of God in truth; 001:007
even as you learned of Epaphras
our beloved fellow servant, who is a
faithful servant of Christ on our**

behalf, 001:008 who also declared to us your love in the Spirit.

001:009 For this cause, we also, since the day we heard this, don't cease praying and making requests for you, that you may be filled with the knowledge of his will in all spiritual wisdom and understanding, 001:010 that you may walk worthily of the Lord, to please him in all respects, bearing fruit in every good work, and increasing in the knowledge of God; 001:011 strengthened with all power, according to the might of his glory, for all endurance and perseverance with joy; 001:012 giving thanks to the Father, who

made us fit to be partakers of the inheritance of the saints in light; 001:013 who delivered us out of the power of darkness, and translated us into the Kingdom of the Son of his love; 001:014 in whom we have our redemption,{TR adds "through his blood,"} the forgiveness of our sins; 001:015 who is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn of all creation. 001:016 For by him all things were created, in the heavens and on the earth, things visible and things invisible, whether thrones or dominions or principalities or powers; all things have been created through him, and for him. 001:017 He is before all things, and

**in him all things are held together.
001:018 He is the head of the body,
the assembly, who is the beginning,
the firstborn from the dead; that in
all things he might have the
preeminence. 001:019 For all the
fullness was pleased to dwell in
him; 001:020 and through him to
reconcile all things to himself, by
him, whether things on the earth,
or things in the heavens, having
made peace through the blood of
his cross. 001:021 You, being in
past times alienated and enemies in
your mind in your evil works,
001:022 yet now he has reconciled
in the body of his flesh through
death, to present you holy and**

**without blemish and blameless
before him, 001:023 if it is so that
you continue in the faith, grounded
and steadfast, and not moved away
from the hope of the Good News
which you heard, which is being
proclaimed in all creation under
heaven; of which I, Paul, was made
a servant. 001:024 Now I rejoice in
my sufferings for your sake, and fill
up on my part that which is lacking
of the afflictions of Christ in my
flesh for his body's sake, which is
the assembly; 001:025 of which I
was made a servant, according to
the stewardship of God which was
given me toward you, to fulfill the
word of God, 001:026 the mystery**

which has been hidden for ages and generations. But now it has been revealed to his saints, 001:027 to whom God was pleased to make known what are the riches of the glory of this mystery among the Gentiles, which is Christ in you, the hope of glory; 001:028 whom we proclaim, admonishing every man and teaching every man in all wisdom, that we may present every man perfect in Christ Jesus; 001:029 for which I also labor, striving according to his working, which works in me mightily.

002:001 For I desire to have you know how greatly I struggle for you, and for those at Laodicea, and

**for as many as have not seen my
face in the flesh; 002:002 that their
hearts may be comforted, they
being knit together in love, and
gaining all riches of the full
assurance of understanding, that
they may know the mystery of God,
both of the Father and of Christ,
002:003 in whom are all the
treasures of wisdom and knowledge
hidden. 002:004 Now this I say that
no one may delude you with
persuasiveness of speech. 002:005
For though I am absent in the flesh,
yet am I with you in the spirit,
rejoicing and seeing your order,
and the steadfastness of your faith
in Christ. 002:006 As therefore you**

**received Christ Jesus, the Lord,
walk in him, 002:007 rooted and
built up in him, and established in
the faith, even as you were taught,
abounding in it in thanksgiving.**

**002:008 Be careful that you don't
let anyone rob you through his
philosophy and vain deceit, after
the tradition of men, after the
elements of the world, and not after
Christ. 002:009 For in him all the
fullness of the Godhead dwells
bodily, 002:010 and in him you are
made full, who is the head of all
principality and power; 002:011 in
whom you were also circumcised
with a circumcision not made with
hands, in the putting off of the**

**body of the sins of the flesh, in the
circumcision of Christ; 002:012
having been buried with him in
baptism, in which you were also
raised with him through faith in the
working of God, who raised him
from the dead. 002:013 You were
dead through your trespasses and
the uncircumcision of your flesh.
He made you alive together with
him, having forgiven us all our
trespasses, 002:014 wiping out the
handwriting in ordinances which
was against us; and he has taken it
out of the way, nailing it to the
cross; 002:015 having stripped the
principalities and the powers, he
made a show of them openly,**

**triumphing over them in it. 002:016
Let no man therefore judge you in
eating, or in drinking, or with
respect to a feast day or a new
moon or a Sabbath day, 002:017
which are a shadow of the things to
come; but the body is Christ's.
002:018 Let no one rob you of your
prize by a voluntary humility and
worshipping of the angels, dwelling
in the things which he has not seen,
vainly puffed up by his fleshly
mind, 002:019 and not holding
firmly to the Head, from whom all
the body, being supplied and knit
together through the joints and
ligaments, grows with God's
growth. 002:020 If you died with**

Christ from the elements of the world, why, as though living in the world, do you subject yourselves to ordinances, 002:021 "Don't handle, nor taste, nor touch" 002:022 (all of which perish with use), according to the precepts and doctrines of men? 002:023 Which things indeed appear like wisdom in self-imposed worship, and humility, and severity to the body; but aren't of any value against the indulgence of the flesh. 003:001 If then you were raised together with Christ, seek the things that are above, where Christ is, seated on the right hand of God. 003:002 Set your mind on the things that are above, not on the

things that are on the earth.

003:003 For you died, and your life is hidden with Christ in God.

003:004 When Christ, our life, is revealed, then you will also be revealed with him in glory. 003:005

Put to death therefore your members which are on the earth: sexual immorality, uncleanness, depraved passion, evil desire, and covetousness, which is idolatry;

003:006 for which things' sake the wrath of God comes on the children of disobedience. 003:007 You also once walked in those, when you lived in them; 003:008 but now you also put them all away: anger, wrath, malice, slander, and

**shameful speaking out of your
mouth. 003:009 Don't lie to one
another, seeing that you have put
off the old man with his doings,
003:010 and have put on the new
man, who is being renewed in
knowledge after the image of his
Creator, 003:011 where there can't
be Greek and Jew, circumcision
and uncircumcision, barbarian,
Scythian, bondservant, freeman;
but Christ is all, and in all. 003:012
Put on therefore, as God's chosen
ones, holy and beloved, a heart of
compassion, kindness, lowliness,
humility, and perseverance;
003:013 bearing with one another,
and forgiving each other, if any**

man has a complaint against any; even as Christ forgave you, so you also do. 003:014 Above all these things, walk in love, which is the bond of perfection. 003:015 And let the peace of God rule in your hearts, to which also you were called in one body; and be thankful. 003:016 Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly; in all wisdom teaching and admonishing one another with psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs, singing with grace in your heart to the Lord. 003:017 Whatever you do, in word or in deed, do all in the name of the Lord Jesus, giving thanks to God the Father, through him. 003:018

Wives, be in subjection to your husbands, as is fitting in the Lord.

003:019 Husbands, love your wives, and don't be bitter against them.

003:020 Children, obey your parents in all things, for this pleases the Lord. 003:021 Fathers, don't provoke your children, so that they won't be discouraged.

003:022 Servants, obey in all things those who are your masters according to the flesh, not just when they are looking, as men pleasers, but in singleness of heart, fearing God. 003:023 And whatever you do, work heartily, as for the Lord, and not for men, 003:024 knowing that from the Lord you

will receive the reward of the inheritance; for you serve the Lord Christ. 003:025 But he who does wrong will receive again for the wrong that he has done, and there is no partiality. 004:001 Masters, give to your servants that which is just and equal, knowing that you also have a Master in heaven. 004:002 Continue steadfastly in prayer, watching therein with thanksgiving; 004:003 praying together for us also, that God may open to us a door for the word, to speak the mystery of Christ, for which I am also in bonds; 004:004 that I may reveal it as I ought to speak. 004:005 Walk in wisdom

**toward those who are outside,
redeeming the time. 004:006 Let
your speech always be with grace,
seasoned with salt, that you may
know how you ought to answer
each one. 004:007 All my affairs
will be made known to you by
Tychicus, the beloved brother,
faithful servant, and fellow
bondservant in the Lord. 004:008 I
am sending him to you for this very
purpose, that he may know your
circumstances and comfort your
hearts, 004:009 together with
Onesimus, the faithful and beloved
brother, who is one of you. They
will make known to you everything
that is going on here. 004:010**

Aristarchus, my fellow prisoner greets you, and Mark, the cousin of Barnabas (concerning whom you received commandments, "if he comes to you, receive him"), 004:011 and Jesus who is called Justus, who are of the circumcision. These are my only fellow workers for the Kingdom of God, men who have been a comfort to me. 004:012 Epaphras, who is one of you, a servant of Christ, salutes you, always striving for you in his prayers, that you may stand perfect and complete in all the will of God. 004:013 For I testify about him, that he has great zeal for you, and for those in Laodicea, and for those

in Hierapolis. 004:014 Luke, the beloved physician, and Demas greet you. 004:015 Greet the brothers who are in Laodicea, and Nymphas, and the assembly that is in his house. 004:016 When this letter has been read among you, cause it to be read also in the assembly of the Laodiceans; and that you also read the letter from Laodicea. 004:017 Tell Archippus, "Take heed to the ministry which you have received in the Lord, that you fulfill it." 004:018 The salutation of me, Paul, with my own hand: remember my bonds. Grace be with you. Amen.

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